# Teaching- and Examination Regulations Master Design Academy Eindhoven 2026-2027

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## Article 1 General provisions and definitions

1. This regulation is a Teaching- and Examination Regulation (TER) as specified in Article 7.13 WHW;
    a. The provisions contained in these regulations are only legally valid if and insofar as they do not conflict with stipulations made in law or pursuant to Dutch law;
    b. The regulations are adopted by DAE's Executive Board with the consent of the MCC and in consultation with the Examination Board.
2. The scope of these regulations is restricted to Master students and staff at DAE who fall under the jurisdiction of DAE's Executive Board. The Executive Board is responsible for regular assessment of the TER, for the purpose of monitoring and, where necessary, adjusting the study load. The Executive Board considers the time students are required to spend on the education as a result of the study load.
3. In accordance with Section 7.13 of the WHW, the TER is part of this Student Charter and is available on DAE's online platforms.
4. In this chapter, the following additional definitions apply:
    a. Programme of study: DAE's full-time Master degree programme, Design track, within the generic Master of Arts in Fine Art and Design (MFAD – CROHO 49114).
    b. Department: the Master degree programme is divided into five research departments: Contextual Design, Social Design, Information Design, the Critical Inquiry Lab and Geo-Design.
    c. Examination: takes place in the last trimester of the second year of study, Module 6b, in the form of a final examination during which the final design is presented and the Master degree thesis is submitted.
    d. Research proposal: assignment in Module 3b (see article 3), that students must complete in preparation for the second year of study.
    e. Master proof: part of the examination centred around the verbal presentation of the project.
5. Due to the specific nature, structure and quality of the education and the students' backgrounds, the education, evaluations, assessments and examinations are conducted in English, in accordance with the Code of Conduct adopted by the Executive Board (Section 7.2(c) of the WHW).



## Article 2 Exemptions for Master programme

Following consultation with the head of the Master degree programme, the Examination Board is authorised to grant partial exemptions to students who have acquired certain skills through study or work experience before being admitted to DAE. These skills have present qualities equal to the learning outcomes and criteria at DAE.

## Article 3 Structure of Master programme

1. The Master degree programme is structured as follows (see Appendix 1):
   Year 1: Module 1; Module 2; Module 3a; Module 3b.
   Year 2: Module 4; Module 5; Module 6a; Module 6b.
2. The first year represents a study load of 60 EC, as can be seen in the Credit Table in Appendix 1. It focusses on developing research and design methods. The first year includes the following modules:
    a. Module 1 (20 EC) in which students discover research and design methods;
    b. Module 2 (20 EC) in which students deepen and apply their understanding of research and design methods.
    c. Module 3 consists of two parallel parts:
        i. Module 3a (10 EC) in which students specify their research and design methods through an individual or a collaborative assignment.

ii. Module 3b (10 EC) in which a research proposal is developed in preparation for the second year.

3. The second year is the final year of the two-year Master degree programme, represents a study load of 60 EC (see Appendix 1) and focuses on the graduation research and the final design. It consists of the following modules:
    a. Module 4 (20 EC), in which the student conducts research and starts writing the thesis.
    b. Module 5 (20 EC), students finalise the thesis and start the design project.
    c. Module 6 (20 EC) in which Masterproof, thesis and graduation design project are assessed in final exam with an external examiner. All components of final exam are assessed without an external examiner during a compulsory midterm. During this assessment the Assessment Committee assesses its confidence in whether the student is able to successfully complete the final examination.



## Article 4 Assessment procedure of Master programme

1. Each module ends with an evaluation to examine and assess the knowledge, insights and skills of the student for that specific module.
2. To be assessed, one must be enrolled as a student.
3. Students are given the opportunity to take assessments for the modules within the Master programme at least twice per academic year.
4. The first opportunity is the standard assessment, which takes place at the end of the module.
5. Not attending an assessment opportunity is forfeiting that opportunity for assessment. The student will receive the assessment NP (not present).
6. The second opportunity takes place during the redo week(s). The planning of these can be found in the Calendarium.
7. The right to a redo applies in the following cases only:
    a. The result of the standard assessment moment is insufficient.
    b. The student was absent during the regular assessment moment, irrespective of the reason, which automatically results in an NP (Not Present). This means that opportunity was not taken and thus not passed.
8. If the redo assignment is assessed to be sufficient, the module is deemed to be passed successfully.
9. If there are no more opportunities for assessment, the course component needs to be completed fully when the course component is next taught in the programme of study (the next academic year).
10. Students conclude the first year of the programme, which entails a study load of 60 EC, once they have successfully completed all first-year modules. Students may only progress to the second year once they have successfully completed these 60 EC in the first year.
11. Students who have not successfully completed Modules 4 and/or 5 of the second year are entitled to resit (redo) each module by means of a redo assignment. The redo assignment is formulated by the Assessment Committee and is assessed during the midterms of the following module (Module 4 redo during Module 5 midterm, and Module 5 redo during Module 6 midterm).
12. All assessments or examinations of course components within the Master programme are taken by the student individually, in written or oral form and by means of the presentation or exhibition of completed work, at DAE or at another location designated by DAE.
13. As a rule, oral examinations and evaluations are not open to the public; in exceptional cases, the Examination Board may decide to deviate from this rule. Recording of assessments or examinations for public use is strictly forbidden.
14. Students who are ill or who will be absent from an evaluation must inform the coordinator of the course component in question of the situation no later than 9:30 am on the date of the evaluation. These students will sit the evaluation or examination at the next opportunity.

15. DAE ensures that the student administration is provided with the necessary data for recording marks in the OSIRIS student tracking system. This record will be made available to the student within ten working days after the assessment results have been determined.
16. A student who has participated in an assessment can review the completed assessment form in the student tracking system within 10 working days of the assessment date.
17. The Examination Board establishes regulations to ensure the proper conduct of assessments.
18. If there are no more opportunities for assessment, the course component needs to be completed fully when the course component is next taught in the programme of study.
19. If a student either misses or fails both the first and second assessment opportunities, they may submit a request to the Examination Board for an additional (third) assessment opportunity (extra assessment) after receiving the results. This request must be submitted in writing within 10 days of receiving the results.
20. A third assessment opportunity is only granted in cases of exceptional personal circumstances like physical and mental disability, which must be supported by documentation and known timely by the student counsellor.
21. When deciding on an extra assessment, additional conditions may be imposed, such as achieving a minimum percentage of completed assignments or meeting attendance requirements for the course.
22. The decision of the Examination Board is final and will be communicated to the student in writing.
23. The statutory validity of the successfully completed assessments is 10 years, calculated from the day on which the result in question was achieved. Students who begin the programme later, or who resume their studies following an absence, are assigned an amended study programme by the Examination Board, taking into consideration the course components the student has already passed and the requirements of the current study programme.
24. Students with a disability or other extenuating circumstances will be offered the opportunity to take the evaluation in an adapted manner. Students who wish to claim eligibility for adaptations must submit a request in writing to the Examination Board, giving reasons. The Examination Board issues its decision within four weeks following receipt of the request, unless the request requires further investigation, in which case the student will be notified when clarification of the request is available.
25. Students can appeal the Committee of Examiners' decisions to the Board of Appeals for the Exams (see Chapter 10 of the Student Charter).



## Article 5 Assessment criteria of Master programme

1. The following criteria apply to the assessment of Modules 1, 2 and 3a in the first year:
    A. RESEARCH & ANALYSIS: research, reflection and analysis
    B. VISION & CONCEPT: synthesis of research and design concept
    C. DESIGN: design and visual presentation of the design
    D. ENGAGEMENT: attitude and involvement
    E. PRESENTATION & COMMUNICATION: visual and oral presentation and communication of the research and design
    a. For each module, marks are awarded for the results of these individual components. The marks gained for the module projects are collected on an evaluation list. The list of marks consists of a mark for each of the criteria in (10).
    b. The assessment is expressed as a mark with the following meaning and written feedback to support that mark:

        1 = very insufficient
        2 = insufficient

3 = sufficient
4 = good
5 = excellent
NP = Not present

c. Students pass a module once all the following conditions have been met:
   - The total of the marks for the five components (A–E) is at least 14 so that the average of the marks for the five components is at least 2.8;
   - The mark for the design (C) is not awarded a 1.

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2. A separate assessment form is applied for the assessment of Module 3b.
3. For the assessment of Modules 4 and 5 in the second year, the following criteria apply for each module:
   A. RESEARCH & ANALYSIS: research, reflection and analysis
   B. VISION & CONCEPT: synthesis of research and design concept
   C. DESIGN: design and visual presentation of the design
   D. THESIS: research report, conclusion, visions and design, translated into an autonomous communicative product (in writing or in an alternative format)
   E. MASTER PROOF: visual and oral presentation and communication of the research and design

   a. For each module, marks are awarded for the results of these individual components. The marks gained for the module projects are collected on an evaluation list. The list of marks consists of a mark for each of the criteria in (17).
   b. The assessment is expressed as a mark with the following meaning and written feedback to support that mark:
      1 = very insufficient
      2 = insufficient
      3 = sufficient
      4 = good
      5 = excellent
      NP = Not present
   c. Students pass a module once all the following conditions have been met:
      - The total of the marks for the five components (A – E) is at least 14, so that the average of the marks for the five components is at least 2.8.
      - Compensation between design (C) and thesis (D) is not permitted: neither of these criteria can be awarded a 1 and the average of both criteria may not be lower than 3;
   d. Students are admitted to the graduation phase in Module 6 once they have obtained the 100 EC of Modules 1, 2, 3a, 3b, 4 and 5.
4. The criteria for Module 6 are outlined in Article 7.10.

## Article 6 End qualifications of Master programme

1. These are the end qualifications for the first year:
    a. Students have developed a sufficiently independent, inquiring, flexible attitude regarding the field of study and the relevant social context.
    b. Students have developed sufficient understanding and knowledge and use these faculties with respect to the themes researched.
    c. Students have acquired sufficient understanding of the full breadth of the chosen department (Contextual Design (CD), Social Design (SD), Information Design (ID), the Critical Inquiry Lab (CIL), GEO-Design (GEO)).
    d. The student is able to formulate a sound research trajectory and positioning.
    e. Students have developed an individual vision and have demonstrated the ability to translate this into a design.
    f. Students are thoroughly acquainted with relevant cultural and social aspects and can work contextually with these aspects.
    g. Students present their work appropriately, both orally and visually, to individuals and to larger groups.
2. These are the end qualifications for the second year:
    a. Students possess the knowledge, skills, understanding and attitude to be able to conduct thorough research which results in an analysis and conclusion, and they have the knowledge, skills, understanding and attitude to draft a valid report (written thesis or alternative format).
    b. Students are capable of engaging in research through material practice.
    c. Students can communicate their research through materiality and aesthetics to an audience.
    d. Students have gained significant sensitivity to the contextual factors including political, ecological, economic, technological, cultural and geographic factors, that are relevant to the theme of their research.
    e. Students have developed the attitude of an innovative, creative thinker within their department (Contextual Design, Social Design, Information Design, the Critical Inquiry Lab, Geo-Design).
    f. Students are able to use their knowledge, understanding and skills to control processes, to organise projects and to work collaboratively.
    g. Students are capable of creating networks relating to their projects and activities, and to sustain these networks in the long term.

## Article 7 Graduation phase of Master programme

1. Students are entitled to participate in the final examination once they have gained 100 EC and therefore successfully completed all five preceding Modules.
2. Students are required to sit the examination at the first available opportunity, as soon as they obtain 100 EC, unless the Examination Board unless the Examination Board has agreed to a request for a later opportunity.
3. The starting date and finishing date of Module 6 are determined by the Executive Board. The date on which the examination takes place is determined by the Executive Board in close consultation with the Examination Board. The week in which the examination takes place must be made known at least five months in advance. The date on which the examination takes place must be made known at least one month in advance.
4. The date by which the thesis must be submitted is determined for each department prior to the start of the academic year and is recorded in the department's annual plan, as is the deadline for requesting an extension. Requesting an extension is done by submitting a request to the Examination Board.
5. During the graduation phase, the candidate is required to keep all supervising teachers informed of the progress and process of their (graduation) assignments. Candidates who fail to meet this requirement may be excluded from the examination by the Executive Board.

6. The graduation topic is determined by the candidate in consultation with the assessment committee, chaired by the head of the department. The graduation topic is developed through in-depth research and a thesis, as well as a fully elaborated materialised design.
7. Prior to the examination, the green light assessment takes place in Module 6a. The green light assessment serves as a final rehearsal for the examination, during which no external examiner is present.
8. If a graduation assignment has been carried out under the guidance of experts who are not members of the teaching team, these experts may be invited to provide their assessment of the portion of the graduation assignment in which they were involved, provided that the committee of examiners deems this necessary and they are appointed by the Examination Board. Their assessment will be taken into account in the evaluation of the graduation assignment.
9. Except with written permission from the head of the department, the candidate is not permitted to enter into commercial collaborations or agreements with third parties for their graduation assignment.
10. The following criteria are applied in the assessment of the results of the graduation assignments:
    A. RESEARCH & ANALYSIS: research, reflection and analysis
    B. VISION & CONCEPT: synthesis of research and design concept
    C. DESIGN: design and visual presentation of the design
    D. THESIS: research report, conclusion, visions and design, translated into an autonomous communicative product (in writing or in an alternative format)
    E. MASTER PROOF: visual and oral presentation and communication of the research and design

    a. The result is expressed in marks from 1 to 5 inclusive for each criteria, which have the following meaning:

        1 = very insufficient
        2 = insufficient
        3 = sufficient
        4 = good
        5 = excellent
        NP = Not present

    b. The chair of the Committee of Examiners, usually the head of the department, will require the candidate to present their graduation assignment for a maximum of eight minutes during the final examination, followed by questions.
    c. The DAE diploma is awarded if all the following conditions have been met:
        1. The total of the marks for the five criteria (A – E) is at least 14;
        2. Compensation between design (C) and thesis (D) is not permitted: neither of these criteria can be awarded a 1 and the average of both criteria may not be lower than 3;
        3. The average of the marks for the five components is at least 2.8.

d. The decision about whether the candidate has passed the examination will be taken during a meeting of the Committee of Examiners, taking into consideration the recommendations of all examiners. The Committee will inform the candidate of its decision after the meeting.
e. Students who pass the final examination will receive a degree certificate from the Examination Board stating the grade of the examination as evidence. If a candidate is found not to have been correctly enrolled in any year but that candidate has nevertheless benefited from education or sat assessments, the Executive Board may determine that the degree certificate can only be awarded once the relevant tuition fee has been paid. The title of Master of Arts (MA) will be awarded, if possible, immediately following the announcement of the results, and in all cases within two weeks. This certificate is signed, at a minimum, by the chair of the Examination Board and the head of the department. They also receive a diploma supplement together with the certificate referred to in (f), which describes the completed programme of study in greater detail. An overview of the total marks is included in the diploma supplement. The supplement is signed by the chair of the Examination Board.
f. The cum laude committee is entitled to grant the designation 'cum laude' if the criteria C (design) and D (thesis) have been assessed with 4 or more points and a total of at least 20 points have been gained across all five criteria. Additionally, the projects must focus on new and important conditions for the design field at large.

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11. Candidates who do not satisfy the standards referred to in 7.10.c. will be given the opportunity to redo the examination.
12. The redo must take place at the first available opportunity, as determined by the chair of the Examination Board.
13. Candidates who do not satisfy the standards referred to in 7.10.c after resitting the examination must sit the next examination with new graduation assignments.
14. The chair of Examination Board determines the schedule for the redo examinations, which can take place in August of the academic year in question.
15. The provisions for the examination contained in these regulations also apply to the redo examination.
16. Candidates who, for reasons which the chair of the Examination Board considers to be unforeseen and compelling, are prevented from sitting the examination are offered the opportunity to sit the examination before the start of the meeting.
17. If, with regard to the provisions of this article or with regard to fraud (see Student Charter 2.7.2.e), a candidate for graduation has, in the opinion of the board of examiners, been guilty of any cheating (or fraud) or has acted contrary to the regulations in any other respect, and this is discovered before or during the examination, the chairman of the Examination Board will deny the examinee participation or further participation in the examination, after the chairman of the Examination Board has heard the examinee in question on this matter.
    a. If the deception is discovered after the examination, the chair of the Examination Board will withhold the degree certificate from the candidate. If another irregularity is discovered after the examination, the chair of the Examination Board is authorised to withhold the degree certificate from the candidate.
    b. The chair of the Examination Board immediately notifies the Inspectorate of any deception or irregularity as referred to above. If this notification is made verbally, it is then confirmed in writing to the Inspectorate.

c. If the chair of the Examination Board applies (a) or (b) above, the chair immediately sends the candidate, by registered mail, a copy of the letter referred to above; at the same time the chair will specify to the candidate in writing the provisions of the subsection in question.

18. In all cases not covered by these regulations, the chair of the Executive Board will decide. As soon as possible, the Executive Board will notify the Inspectorate, the chair of the Examination Board and the members of the Committee of Examiners of the decision in accordance with chapter 10 of the Student Charter.
19. The Executive Board ensures that a copy of the description of the graduation projects and examination requirements is stored in DAE's archives for seven years. The Executive Board ensures that the assessment of each candidate's graduation projects and the result of each candidate's examination are stored in DAE's archives for ten years.
20. Students with disabilities will be offered the opportunity to sit the evaluation in an appropriate manner. Students who wish to claim eligibility for adaptations must submit a well-founded request, in writing and in a timely manner, to the Examination Board. The Examination Board determines timeliness case by case. If necessary, the Examination Board will seek expert advice (for example from the student counsellor) before making its decision. The Examination Board issues its decision within four weeks following receipt of the request, unless the request requires further investigation, in which case the student will be notified when clarification of the request is available.
21. Persons who have passed the final examination that is linked to the generic Master degree programme MFAD CROHO 49114 are entitled to use the title of Master of Arts (MA) associated with the Master of Arts in Fine Art and Design.
22. A student who has not passed the examination or who discontinues their studies at DAE prematurely may, upon request, receive a certified transcript of their achieved results from the student administration.
23. A student who does not agree with the decision(s) of the Examination Board and/or the Committee of Examiners may appeal to the CoBEx, as referred to in Chapter 11. The student must submit this appeal request to loket@designacademy.nl, in accordance with the provisions of Chapter 11.

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## Article 8 Concluding provisions

1. Amendments to these regulations are adopted separately by the Executive Board.
2. No amendments will be made during the ongoing study year unless those amendments are to the students' advantage.
3. The current revision enters into force on 1 September 2026. These regulations were adopted by the decision of the Executive Board of DAE, dated 01-08-2026, with the consent of the MCC and following consultation with the Examination Board.

# APPENDIX 1
# MASTER CREDIT TABLE 2026-2027



| FIRST YEAR | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Trimester 1 | | Trimester 2 | | Trimester 3 | | 1 study year | |
| Module 1 | 20EC | Module 2 | 20EC | Module 3A | 10EC | | |
| | | | | Module 3B (thesis proposal) | 10EC | | |
| *Total trimester 1* | 20EC | *Total trimester 2* | 20EC | *Total trimester 3* | 20EC | Total year 1 | 60EC |

| SECOND YEAR | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Trimester 1 | | Trimester 2 | | Trimester 3 | | 1 study year | |
| Module 4 (thesis research) | 20EC | Module 5 (Design) | 20EC | Module 6A (green light) | 10EC | | |
| | | | | Module 6B (final exam) | 10EC | | |
| *Total trimester 1* | 20EC | *Total trimester 2* | 20EC | *Total trimester 3* | 20EC | Total year 2 | 60EC |

| Total Master Programme |
|---|
| 120EC |

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